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Peking May 15th
Mr. Wallis
No. 120
Confidential

Rec. July 21

The Japanese Ambassador.
His pretentions.

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Peking
May 15. 1873.

!120
tential

My Lord,

The Japanese Ambassador, Soyosima, arrived with a large suite about five days ago. He is accompanied by General Legendre, who has rank as a Japanese official of the second grade, as his adviser. This gentleman has called on me, but we have not met. From what he has said to one or two of my colleagues, I infer that he is guiding his Japanese chief in a direction more pretentious than wise. He claims for him not only

?arl Granville. K.G.

&c &c &c

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the degree of Ambafsador, but all the privileges to which Ambafsadors become entitled when they have been received by the Sovereign to whom they are accredited. Amongst other things he endeavoured, through Monsieur Flaugergues, the Doyen, to induce the Corps Diplomatique at once to call upon the Ambafsador, and he closed a long Memorandum upon the subject with an intimation that the Ambafsador, who was a chief representative of progress in Japan, might be converted to a backward policy, if he were treated by foreign Ministers with

Coldness

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coldness.

He presented his in person to Monsieur Rangaly, who appears on his part to have given him good advice; so good, that, later in the day, Monsieur Legendre wrote to withdraw his Memorandum and to intimate that the Japanese Ambassador would call privately at the Foreign Legations.

Monsieur Legendre wrote again to-day to say that the visit was only postponed on account of the severe indisposition of the Ambassador.

His Excellency has not yet been received by the Prince of Hung. Indeed it is understood that he claims the Prince's visit.

This

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This may account for the ten days' sick leave which His Highness has just obtained

It is worthy of note that one of Monsieur Vlangaly's remarks to Monsieur Legendre was upon the danger of isolating himself in Peking. He had told him, he said, that he, Monsieur Vlangaly, had signed one or two Collective Notes <u>of which he had himself disapproved</u>, rather than separate himself from his colleagues, because he knew the risk of isolation

The Chinese manifest, in one way or another, considerable

disgust

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disgust at the tone of the Japanese, and as I have mentioned before, their sudden perversion from their ancient ways. The Chinese, I have good reason to believe, are, at the same time, much alarmed for the security of Formosa as, among the rumors current, is one that the Japanese contemplate annexation of that island.

Their only plea at present known to us is that I have before referred to, viz: the murder of some shipwrecked Lewchewans by the cannibals on the West Coast of Formosa; the Japanese contending that they are the proper protectors of Lewchews.

The

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The ratifications of the Japanese Treaty, there is little doubt, have been exchanged at Tientsin, but the supplementary treaty or Article which it was thought to be one of the objects of this mission to obtain, has not been conceded.

I have the honor to be with the highest Respect,

My Lord,

Your Lordship's most obedient,

Humble Servant,

Thomas Francis Wade.